

Mutton Biryani

Ingredients Overview

- **Mutton Marination (1 kg):** Combined with yogurt, ginger-garlic paste, lemon juice, salt, and spices (chili, turmeric, and garam/biryani masala).
- **Rice (750g Basmati):** Soaked, then boiled with whole spices and salt.
- **Base & Layering:** Thinly sliced onions, ghee, oil, whole spices, fresh mint, coriander, green chilies, and saffron-infused milk.

6-Step Cooking Process

1. **Marinate (2–4 hours):** Mix the mutton with the marination ingredients and refrigerate (bring to room temperature before cooking).
2. **Fry Onions (15 mins):** Fry sliced onions in ghee and oil until crispy; set aside 75% of them (*birista*) for layering.
3. **Cook Mutton (40 mins):** Sauté whole spices and marinated meat in the remaining oil. Simmer or pressure cook until the mutton is 90% tender and the gravy thickens.
4. **Par-boil Rice (15 mins):** Boil the soaked Basmati rice with whole spices and salt until *al dente* (70-80% cooked), then drain.
5. **Layer (10 mins):** Layer half of the herbs and fried onions over the mutton, cover evenly with the hot rice, and top with the remaining herbs, onions, and saffron milk.
6. **Dum Cook (20 mins):** Seal the pot tightly with foil/a towel and a lid. Cook on the lowest heat for 15–20 minutes, then let it rest for 10 minutes before serving.

Pro Tip: Place a flat iron griddle (*tawa*) under the pot during the final steam (dum) phase to act as a heat diffuser and prevent the bottom layer from burning.

Mutton biryani is a globally celebrated, slow-cooked delicacy featuring tender marinated goat or lamb layered with aromatic basmati rice. It is a nutrient-dense complete meal that evolved from Persian and Central Asian cooking methods, which were perfected in the royal kitchens of India. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#)]

Regional Variations and Styles

India's diverse states have put their own unique spin on this classic dish:

- **Hyderabadi:** The most iconic version, prepared in the *kachhi dum* (raw meat cooked with parboiled rice) style, typically served with Mirchi ka Salan and Raita.
- **Kolkata:** Features the addition of a soft, golden-fried potato and boiled egg alongside the meat, a tradition started to stretch the dish during food shortages. [[1](#)]
- **Thalassery:** Found in Kerala, this variant swaps basmati for the small-grained, highly aromatic *Kaima* rice. [[1](#)]
- **Ambur:** A famous Tamil Nadu style characterized by its spicy profile and use of short-grained *Seeraga Samba* rice.